

God's Will and Testament

Let us begin where we left off, reviewing Hebrews 9:13. Last week I spent time going back into adoption, covenant versus sonship, and adoption being complete.

God used my own family to teach me this. Three of our children were naturally born, and two were adopted. He asked me how David, my oldest son, comes to me when he wants something.

I said, "Totally on sonship."

When the children raid the refrigerator, they do not pull out papers and say, "I am going to take a sandwich." They just take it. "I am your child."

There is no difference between David, Bill, Steve, Daniel, and Tawny. Adoption is complete. If Daniel or Tawny pulled out adoption papers as a basis for receiving what the other children simply receive as sons, it would insult me beyond measure. They are my son and daughter, bone of my bone and marrow of my marrow.

Hebrews 9:13-14 says:

"For if the blood of bulls and of goats,
and the ashes of an heifer sprinkling the unclean,
sanctifieth to the purifying of the flesh:
how much more shall the blood of Christ,
who through the eternal Spirit
offered himself without spot to God,
purge your conscience from dead works
to serve the living God?"

The blood of bulls and goats sanctified only to the purifying of the flesh. It could not touch the spirit. The blood of Christ went to the spirit and purged the conscience by giving a new nature.

When John says, "In Him was life, and the life was the light of men," that life was in His human spirit. He was the first human spirit born spiritually alive in four thousand years, and that life was about to become our light. When we were quickened together with Him, the same life in His spirit came into ours.

Now our nature is the same kind of nature as His, and we have access from darkness to light with the capacity to understand God.

Hebrews 9:15 says:

"And for this cause
he is the mediator of the new testament,
that by means of death,
for the redemption of the transgressions
that were under the first testament,
they which are called
might receive the promise of eternal inheritance."

Hebrews is primarily written to the Jew. Paul is differentiating between the covenant given to Abraham, to which the law was added because of transgression, and the covenant given to the whole world, including the Jew, that results in sonship.

Jesus was born of a woman, born under the law, to redeem those under the law. Galatians says He became the curse of the law to redeem those under it so they also could receive the adoption of sons.

Because He was born under the law, He was obligated to keep it. The problem for every other Jew was that this was impossible. Romans 7 shows the dilemma: a spiritually dead man receives the commandment and discovers he cannot keep it.

But Jesus was the first man in four thousand years born spiritually alive. He had no nature of sin. He fulfilled the law, then stepped into the shoes of every Jew who could not keep it and became the curse in their place.

Hebrews 9:16-17 says:

"For where a testament is,
there must also of necessity be the death of the testator.
For a testament is of force after men are dead:
otherwise it is of no strength at all
while the testator liveth."

A testament is the final will. You can have a living will, but a testament is the last one. The death of the Testator made it final.

What I love is that Jesus died as the Testator of our will and rose as the Firstborn from the dead to administer it. He wanted to make sure you would have to be willfully ignorant to lose your inheritance.

He is called the Firstborn from the dead. That cannot be speaking merely of physical resurrection, because there were physical resurrections before Jesus, including Lazarus. He is the Firstborn from spiritual death into resurrection life, the Firstborn among many brethren.

No longer will I stand outside my Father's house and scream that I have a covenant and want something to eat. I go inside and say, "I am Your son." I am the beneficiary of the will and testament of my oldest Brother, Jesus.

Hebrews 10:1 says:

"For the law having a shadow
of good things to come,
and not the very image of the things,
can never with those sacrifices
which they offered year by year continually
make the comers thereunto perfect."

If those sacrifices had perfected the worshipers, they would have ceased to be offered. Instead, in those sacrifices there was a remembrance of sins every year, because it is not possible for the blood of bulls and goats to take away sins.

Then Jesus says:

"Lo, I come
(in the volume of the book it is written of me,)
to do thy will, O God."

Circle "will." He came to do the will of God. He took away the first so He could establish the second.

Hebrews 10:10 says:

"By the which will
we are sanctified
through the offering of the body of Jesus Christ
once for all."

The Testator came in the volume of the Book to fulfill the will. By that will, we are sanctified once for all.

One day you were in a service when the will of God was read. Someone preached the death of the Testator, the Man who came in the volume of the Book to fulfill the will, died, and rose again.

The will said you could have eternal life, inheritance with God, and sonship. You accepted it, and it was fulfilled in you. You became a son.

Is that will still in force? Yes, but now it is for the rest of the world. God wants you to read that will to sinners. With sinners He has a covenant unto sonship. With you, the will has already been received.

Hebrews testifies twice that God writes His laws in our hearts and minds and remembers our sins no more. Hebrews 8:7-12 says:

"For if that first covenant had been faultless,
then should no place have been sought for the second."

The first was not faultless because men under it were not born again. God says:

"I will put my laws into their mind,
and write them in their hearts:
and I will be to them a God,
and they shall be to me a people:
and they shall not teach every man his neighbour,
and every man his brother, saying,
Know the Lord:
for all shall know me,
from the least to the greatest.
For I will be merciful to their unrighteousness,
and their sins and their iniquities
will I remember no more."

Under the old order, the Ten Commandments were external commandments given to a spiritually dead nation that could not keep them. Under the new, God writes that nature into our hearts and minds. Now all can know Him from the least to the greatest through the new nature.

God had no pleasure in the sacrifices of animals, and He took no pleasure in the suffering of His Son. When Jesus prayed, "If it be possible, let this cup pass from Me," He was saying, "If there is any other way mankind can be redeemed, let this pass from Me."

There was no other way. Heaven had run every equation, so to speak. God is immutable; He cannot change. He is sovereign, and all His attributes are sovereign. He is also love, and love is not a dictator. Therefore, He had to give His creatures a will.

That is why Satan created such havoc. The life God gave him was sovereignly his life. Even when he turned and used that life against God, it was still the life God had given him. Adam also received life and used his will wrongly.

God could not change Himself into something that could fellowship with fallen Adam. It took four thousand years, at unfathomable cost, to bring humanity back into something God could fellowship with.

You have no idea what your life and will cost Him. That is why it moves the Father beyond comprehension when hell comes at you from four directions, believing it has broken you, and you take the will that cost God so much and lift your hands to worship Him.

When hell lies to you and you choose to say, "I am going to worship my Father," it moves Him deeply.

Colossians says the holy days, Sabbaths, offerings, and ordinances were shadows of things to come, but the body is Christ.

Once the body that made the shadow has come, why live in the shadow? You cannot start in the Spirit and be perfected by the flesh. You cannot be born again and then return to ordinances, Sabbaths, holy days, and external shadows as though they complete you.

The Sabbath was a type of the new birth. It was the rest we enter when we are born again and cease from our own labors. That is why no one could even pick up sticks on the Sabbath without judgment. In type, picking up sticks said, "There is another way to be saved by my works." There is no other way.

Stay out of the shadow. We know Him now through the new nature and sonship, not through ordinances.

Romans 2 brings us back to the standard by which we now walk. I am a son, and the laws have changed. The law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus has made me free from the law of sin and death.

The Spirit of life is my born-again human spirit. The law that emanates from that new nature is the law that set me free from the law that used to emanate from my spiritually dead spirit. That old law said spiritual death would produce sin. The new law says I am free.

Romans 2:11-13 says:

"For there is no respect of persons with God.
For as many as have sinned without law
shall also perish without law:
and as many as have sinned in the law
shall be judged by the law;
for not the hearers of the law are just before God,
but the doers of the law shall be justified."

That seems to contradict Romans 3:20:

"Therefore by the deeds of the law
there shall no flesh be justified in his sight:
for by the law is the knowledge of sin."

The answer is that no flesh could be justified by the law because no spiritually dead man could keep it. But the Gentile who receives a new nature can do by nature the things contained in the law, because the law has been written in his heart.

Romans 2:14-15 says:

"For when the Gentiles,
which have not the law,
do by nature the things contained in the law,
these, having not the law,
are a law unto themselves:
which shew the work of the law
written in their hearts,
their conscience also bearing witness,
and their thoughts the mean while
accusing or else excusing one another."

This is the new nature. Gentiles who did not have the law by commandment now have the nature of the law written in their hearts. Their conscience bears witness. Their thoughts are accused or excused by that new conscience.

Every time something rises up that is not right, the new nature accuses that thought. If it is right, the new nature excuses it. People say, "I did not know that was wrong." But the Word says the new nature bears witness.

You will face that standard at the judgment seat of Christ. Better to face it now, when it can be cleansed, than to face it then as loss of reward.

The Jew boasted in the law and taught others not to steal, commit adultery, or worship idols, but broke the same law. The Gentile who receives the new nature becomes a law unto himself because the nature of the Ten Commandments is written inside him.

That is why you cannot say you have no witness. The new nature accuses or excuses every thought.